



IS THIS SAFE?

You packed a picnic with cooked chicken, potato salad, and fresh fruit. You kept the cooler closed and in the shade with plenty of ice packs. You served and ate all the food within two hours.



IS THIS SAFE?

A hamburger cooked on a barbecue was left out on the kitchen counter for 5 hours before being eaten.



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to freeze fresh vegetables for future use. You blanched them briefly in boiling water, then froze them immediately. However, the power went out overnight and the vegetables thawed partially before the power returned.



IS THIS SAFE?

You prepare fresh peaches for canning by selecting firm, ripe fruit, washing them thoroughly, and peeling. You follow the exact recommended processing time using a boiling water canner, leaving the right headspace in sterilized jars. After processing, you cool the jars at room temperature without retightening the bands and store the sealed jars in a dark, cool place.



IS THIS SAFE?

You filled jars with mixed fresh fruits and sealed them but didn't add any lemon juice or acid. You process the jars for less than 10 minutes in boiling water and did not adjust processing time for your altitude. You also overfilled the jars with fruit, leaving less than the recommended headspace.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to can slices of Asian pears at home. The recipe doesn't clearly say whether lemon juice is needed. You decide to can them in a boiling water canner, but you are unsure if you should add acid, process longer, or use a pressure canner instead.



IS THIS SAFE?

Jamie used fresh, high-quality Roma tomatoes, peeled and cored them, then added bottled lemon juice before canning the salsa using a boiling water canner for the time recommended in a tested recipe.



IS THIS SAFE?

Alex canned homemade salsa but reduced the amount of vinegar in the recipe by half and added fresh garlic and fresh herbs before processing in a boiling water canner.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Taylor wants to make a salsa with tomatoes and add extra corn and black beans before canning in a boiling water bath. They wonder if it will be safe to do so.

LOW ACID FOODS

Teens (14-18)

LA-T01



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to can green beans, which are low-acid vegetables. You follow a tested recipe precisely, use a pressure canner, maintain the correct pressure and time, and check your dial gauge annually.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned cooked potatoes in a boiling water bath canner instead of a pressure canner and stored the jars at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned a mixture of meat and vegetables in a pressure canner but shortened the recommended processing time by 5 minutes to save time.

PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T01



IS THIS SAFE?

A teenager follows a tested recipe for refrigerator pickles using vinegar with 5% acidity, fresh cucumbers, and sterilized jars. They keep the pickles refrigerated and consume them within 2 weeks.

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



IS THIS SAFE?

Someone tries to make pickles using homemade vinegar without knowing its acidity level and skips processing the jars in boiling water. They store the jars at room temperature for months.

PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T03



IS THIS SAFE?

A teen is making fermented pickles by following a traditional fermentation method but wonders if they have to add enough salt and keep the fermentation environment clean to ensure safety.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You made a strawberry freezer jam using a tested recipe from a low-sugar pectin package and stored it in the freezer right after sealing the jars. You keep the freezer jam frozen until you use it.



IS THIS SAFE?

You canned a batch of peach jam but skipped the boiling water bath processing step and just let the hot jam cool in jars. You plan to store it on your pantry shelf for several months.



IS THIS SAFE?

You want to make a jelly using elderberries you picked yourself. You know there are different varieties with different acidity levels, but you're not sure if yours is safe for standard canning.



IS THIS SAFE?

You freshly cook a batch of vegetable soup and cool it quickly by placing the pot in an ice-water bath, stirring often. Then, you pack the cooled soup into freezer-safe containers, leaving some headspace, and freeze it right away at 0°F (-18°C).



IS THIS SAFE?

You place raw ground meat directly into the freezer without packaging or chilling it first, then find it frozen solid days later. Before cooking, you thaw it on the kitchen counter overnight at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

You froze some leftover cooked rice in a shallow container but left it in the fridge overnight before freezing it. Sometimes you put frozen veggies in the fridge a bit before cooking, but other times you cook them right from the freezer.

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



IS THIS SAFE?

I use an electric dehydrator with a built-in thermostat set to 155°F to dry beef strips for jerky. After drying, I immediately check the temperature and confirm it reached at least 160°F for safety before storing.



IS THIS SAFE?

I smoke fish at home by hanging it outside in an unheated, smoky area without controlling the temperature or time, just guessing when it looks 'done.'



IS THIS SAFE?

I'm drying slices of garden tomatoes which are acidic, but I'm not sure how long to dry them or if I need to heat them before storage.